

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written on four staves in G major (one sharp) and 2/2 time. The melody is simple and folk-like, with lyrics written below the notes. Chord symbols (F, C, Bb) are placed above the staff at various points. The first staff begins with a 3/2 time signature change. The second staff ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'. The third staff begins with a '1' indicating the first ending. The fourth staff ends with a double bar line and the word 'D.C.' (Da Capo).

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...